Social Security Payments Will Go Up 3.6 Percent

From: PBS NewsHour Mined: 2026-10-15 3 min read

Many older Americans will get a **raise** next year. **Social Security** payments will go up by 3.6 percent in 2027. The Associated Press says this adds up to a little more than $900 next year.

Social Security is a government program. It sends monthly money to people who are 62 or older and to people with a **disability** or blindness.

Every year, the **raise** is set by a math **formula** called the cost-of-living adjustment, or COLA. It is tied to **inflation**, which is when prices go up. When prices rise a lot, the **raise** is bigger. The new amount starts in January.

Expert Shai Akabas said this year's **raise** is "not wildly outside of the norm."

Experts said the **raise** may not feel the same for everyone. Older people often spend more on health care. People who drive a lot may also feel it is not enough because gas prices are high.

Word Treasure

Social Security -- Social Security is a U.S. government program that sends monthly money to older people and some others.

disability -- A disability is a condition that makes some everyday activities harder.

formula -- A formula is a math rule used to figure out an answer.

inflation -- Inflation is when prices go up over time.

raise -- A raise is an increase in the money someone gets.

Background you need

Social Security sends monthly money to older Americans and some other people who need help.

Each year, payments can go up so they keep pace with rising prices.

The raise is figured with a math formula based on prices.

Break it down

WHO: Older Americans and people with a disability or blindness who get Social Security
WHAT: Their payments will go up 3.6 percent in 2027
WHERE: Across the United States
WHY: To help payments keep up with rising prices

Why it matters

Many grandparents rely on Social Security, so this raise helps them pay for food and other needs as prices rise.

Test what you remember

1. How much will Social Security payments go up in 2027?

- (A) 10 percent
- (B) 1 percent
- (C) 50 percent
- (D) 3.6 percent

2. About how much extra does the raise add up to next year, according to the Associated Press?

- (A) About $10,000
- (B) Nothing
- (C) A little more than $900
- (D) About $5

3. Who gets Social Security money?

- (A) People 62 or older and people with a disability or blindness
- (B) Only people in cities
- (C) Only teachers
- (D) Only kids

4. What is the yearly raise called?

- (A) The cost-of-living adjustment, or COLA
- (B) The tax refund
- (C) The prize payment
- (D) The holiday bonus

5. When does the new amount start?

- (A) Right now
- (B) In 2030
- (C) In January
- (D) In July

6. Why might people who drive a lot feel the raise is not enough?

- (A) Cars are free
- (B) They get extra money
- (C) Gas prices are high
- (D) Roads are closed

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: C 3: A 4: A 5: C 6: C

Questions to think about

1. **Shai Akabas: He says this year's raise is "not wildly outside of the norm."**
2. **Experts: They say the raise may not feel the same for everyone, since some people spend more on health care or gas.**

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):